

pandemic. Developers work on multiple open source projects without meeting anyone in person, and continue to innovate that way. Open source is naturally built for remote work.

- **Availability of infrastructure:** If an open source project is being developed, there are a lot of free resources offered. And, here are the negatives...
- **Security:** With a lot of things moving forward, security can be an issue. Initiatives like Whitesource, etc, help in collective knowledge of open source security, which may be helpful later.
- **Licensing issues:** After what happened to Elasticsearch and MongoDB, licensing issues can create challenges.
- **Documentation:** Very often, documentation is poor and not made

available to the community that wants to contribute to projects.

- **Single owner components:** People who work with Node.js might have faced this problem of depending on a single owner component. If the component provider does not support your project after some time, it could lead to a lot of problems.

Open source strategy is definitely not a cakewalk, and it's not safe to get into it blindly. It is better to consider the good and bad facets of open source, and make a navigation strategy before jumping into it.

'Sharing knowledge doubles it' and 'Great things are invented, but for them to run, it needs the SUM of great people'. With these two philosophies backing it, open source can be beneficial both for the organisation as well as the

individual. It would be nice if more contributions were made from India. But for that to happen, skills need to be developed.

The earlier definition of open source does not hold true now. The right definition today is: 'Open source is run by great people who do care about money and make affordable business solutions'. **END** 🐧

This article is based on a talk by Sathish Kumar Thiagarajan, Open Source Advocate and Co Organizer of Bangalore Open Source Java User Group, at OSI 2021.

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